

SDGs/Principles of Official Statistics

- The 70th Session of the United Nations (UN) General Assembly held on 25th September 2015 adopted the document titled "Transforming our World: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development" consisting of 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and associated 169 targets. The SDGs seek to address not only the root causes of poverty but also the universal need for development to provide a life of dignity to all. The SDGs are a comprehensive list of global goals integrating social, economic and environmental dimensions of development. Countries have the primary responsibility for follow-up and review, at the national level with regard to the progress made in implementing the goals and targets over the next 15 years.
- The SDGs were formulated as a continuation of the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) and are being implemented globally. The SDGs consist of 17 Goals with 169 targets and form a comprehensive framework for global development. Adopted by UN, it came into force on 1st January, 2016.
- The MDGs were adopted in the year 2000 and the MDG goals were mainly limited to certain aspects of social and economic development. In the 8 MDGs goals, there were only 18 targets. The SDGs on the other hand, are more comprehensive and comprising of all three dimensions of development viz. economic, social and environment.
- The NITI Aayog has been entrusted with the responsibility of overseeing the implementation of SDGs in India. The MoSPI has been entrusted with the responsibility of developing National Indicator Framework for measuring the progress of SDGs and associated targets.

- India is a signatory of the UN resolution adopting SDGs. However, **achieving SDGs is not legally binding or mandatory**. Targets are defined as aspirational and global with each Government setting its own national targets guided by the global level of ambition, but taking into account the national circumstances.

Goals: (17 goals ,169 targets, 232 indicators)



- India subscribes to IMF's SDDS:

India has subscribed to the Special Data Dissemination Standards (SDDS) of the International Monetary Fund (IMF). The subscription carries a commitment to observe the standards and to provide information about its economic and financial data and its dissemination practices to the IMF in the form of Metadata. Accordingly, the metadata for each of the data categories is posted on the IMF's external website on an electronic bulletin board known as the Dissemination Standards Bulletin Board (DSSB). Also, data on quarterly GDP and data pertaining to other real sector categories is transmitted to the IMF's DSSB through the National Summary Data Page (NSDP), to which the DSSB is linked. It is to be noted that presence of a country on the DSSB as a subscriber to the SDDS indicates the intention of member countries to observe certain tenets of good statistical citizenship. As of now, total 71 countries of the world have subscribed to SDDS and 14 countries to SDDS plus. The data of these countries are uploaded on the Dashboard of IMF for facilitating international comparison.

Agency	Publications
UNSD	Statistical Yearbook, World Statistics Pocketbook, Monthly Bulletin of Statistics

-United Nations has recommended that the base period of the index number should be revised quinquennially.

- **Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics**

General Assembly Resolution 68/261 adopted on **29 January 2014**

India adopted these principles through a Cabinet Resolution in May 2016.

Principles	Meaning
1.Relevance, Impartiality, and Equal Access	official statistics that meet the test of practical utility are to be compiled and made available on an impartial basis by official statistical agencies to honour citizens' entitlement to public information.
2.Professional Standards, Scientific Principles, and Professional Ethics	To retain trust in official statistics, the statistical agencies need to decide according to strictly professional considerations, including scientific principles and professional ethics, on the methods and procedures for the collection, processing, storage and presentation of statistical data.
3.Accountability and Transparency	To facilitate a correct interpretation of the data, the statistical agencies are to present information according to scientific standards on the sources, methods and procedures of the statistics.
4.Prevention of Misuse	The statistical agencies are entitled to comment on erroneous interpretation and misuse of statistics.
5.Sources of Official Statistics	Data for statistical purposes may be drawn from all types of sources, be they statistical surveys or administrative records. Statistical agencies are to choose the source with regard to quality, timeliness, costs and the burden on respondents.

6. Confidentiality	Individual data collected by statistical agencies for statistical compilation, whether they refer to natural or legal persons, are to be strictly confidential and used exclusively for statistical purposes.
7. Legislation	The laws, regulations and measures under which the statistical systems operate are to be made public.
8. National Coordination	Coordination among statistical agencies within countries is essential to achieve consistency and efficiency in the statistical system.
9. Use of International Standards	The use by statistical agencies in each country of international concepts, classifications and methods promotes the consistency and efficiency of statistical systems at all official levels.
10. International Cooperation	Bilateral and multilateral cooperation in statistics contributes to the improvement of systems of official statistics in all countries.